[METRIC]

A-A-2788A
October 15, 1996
SUPERSEDING
A-A-2788, dated
December 4, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

# BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF, POST, SOLID AND TELESCOPIC

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all Federal agencies.

1. Scope. This Commercial Item Description covers solid and telescopic-post loose leaf binders equipped with a center locking or end locking device.

2. Classification.

Type I - Lift ring, center locking
Type II - End locking

Class 1 - Four solid posts (see 3.1.12)
Class 2 - Two telescopic posts and sleeves (see 3.1.13)
Class 3 - Three telescopic posts and sleeves (see 3.1.14)
Class 4 - Two telescopic posts and sleeves and one additional post (see 3.1.15)
Class 5 - (see 3.1.16)
Class 6 - (see 3.1.16)
Class 7 - (see 3.1.16)
Class 8 - (see 3.1.17)

Grade A - Coated cloth bound
Grade B - Canvas bound

Size - As specified (see 8.1.2)

Capacity - As specified (see 8.1.2)

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document, should be sent to: General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, 26 Federal Plaza, New York N.Y. 10278 ATTN: Engineering Branch (2FYEE).

FSC 7510

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS:

3.1. Construction: Binders shall consist of two separable covers hinged to overlapping metal angle backs. The angle backs and binder covers shall be bound with the binding material. Posts or telescoping posts and sleeves shall be fastened to angle backs or to the aligner (transfer) bar, or to both, to hold sheets. Color of coated-cloth and canvas-bound binders shall be furnished as specified (see 8.1.4). Binders shall be equipped with the locking device for Type I, and Type II, as specified below.

3.1.1. Type I. The lift ring, center locking device for Type I binders shall be of the quick-operating automatic ball-bearing type with locking post and sleeve. The device shall lock automatically when positioned upon the locking post attached to the bottom angle. The bearing balls shall be secured in the inner sleeve of the locking device by staking the holes, or by the application of an elastic type of adhesive material, or by reducing the maximum internal clearance between the inner and outer sleeves to prevent loss of the bearing balls after assembly. The internal locking mechanism of the sleeve shall be controlled by a securely attached steel lift ring not less than 19 mm (3/4") inside diameter (to allow insertion of a finger), and operated by pulling. As an alternative, the securely mounted steel lift ring shall operate by a cam type mechanism which releases the lock by pivoting to the upright position, without the need for insertion of a finger. The lift ring shall be made of solid stock not less than 1.6 mm (1/16") diameter. The ring shall be designed so that the open ends will be concealed in the locking device (for pull-ring use only). The tubular sleeve of the locking device shall be rigidly and securely affixed to the midpoint of the top angle, extending inward in such position to clear the inner edge of the bound fillers. The exterior diameter of the sleeve shall be approximately 12.7 mm (1/2"). Locking surfaces of locking device, including lock post, bearing balls, and the inner surface of the outer sleeve, which comes in contact with the bearing balls, shall be casehardened.

3.1.2. Type II. The end locking device for Type II binders shall be two telescoping steel cam locks or sleeve and screw combination locks, one at each end of binder, securely fastened to top and bottom covers and operated by steel levers or retaining clips that lock and unlock the binder by slight pressure.

3.1.3. Locking device. The locking device shall hold fillers firmly under compression throughout the full capacity range of the binder and shall permit easy release and removal of the top cover by a single motion. The locking action shall be increased by the expansive tendency of the fillers. The locking device shall operate smoothly and shall not stick or bind on the locking post when tested in accordance with (5.2.1).



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1.4. Covers, angle backs, and hinges shall be bound with a continuous piece of binding material as specified in (3.3.1 & 3.3.2). The binding material shall be carried over the inside face of the covers at least 15.9 mm (5/8") beyond the edges and shall be securely and smoothly glued. The lining paper shall overlap the edges of the binding material at least 12.7 mm (1/2") and shall be securely glued in place.

3.1.5. The hinges for the binders shall be made of any commercially acceptable material.

3.1.6. Angle backs shall be constructed of material specified in (3.3.7). Angle backs shall be edged with a No.4 mill round edge so that the top and bottom edges of both angles will be rounded to protect the fabric against being cut through. Corners shall also be rounded with a corner radius of not less than 6.4 mm (1/4"). Angle backs shall be hinged to covers and shall overlap when binder is assembled. The overlapping angle legs shall be of sufficient depth so that the binder back remains closed within the expansive capacity of the binder.

3.1.7. Posts and sleeves shall be of material specified in (3.3.6), and shall be of the proper length to hold the binder capacity. Posts and sleeves shall be rigidly secured in correct alignment by riveting or other suitable means. All posts shall have rounded or ball type heads.

3.1.8. The aligner bar (transfer bar) for the Type I binder shall be punched to receive the sleeve of the lift-ring locking device.

3.1.9. Binders shall have an index-tab allowance of not less than 12.7 mm (1/2"), plus 6.4 mm (1/4") for overlap, a total allowance of 19 mm (3/4"). Corners of covers at index edge shall be rounded.

3.1.10. When specified, binders shall be furnished with a label holder on the backbone. Unless otherwise specified, the label holder shall be cut in the backbone of the outside angle and shall be equipped with a transparent plastic window and a plain card label insert. Plastic of the cellulose nitrate type will not be acceptable. The holder shall be such that labels may be easily inserted and removed. The fabric surrounding the label holder shall be turned in such a manner that no unfinished edges are visible and the edges will not fray or pull out in normal use. The size of the label holder and its location from the top of the binder backbone shall be as specified (see 8.1.5).

3.1.11. The manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character as to be readily identifiable, shall be printed, heat stamped, or otherwise permanently marked on the inside of one cover of the binder. When specified, the words "Property of U.S. Government," or any other additional marking, shall be included in the marking (see 8.1.7).



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1.12. Class 1. Binders shall contain four solid metal posts, 4.8 ± 0.4 mm (3/16 ± 1/64") in diameter. Two posts shall be attached to the bottom angle spaced on 20.3 cm (8") centers and two posts attached to the transfer bar spaced on 10.2 cm (4") centers.

3.1.13. Class 2. Two solid steel posts, not less than 4.8 mm (3/16") diameter, shall be firmly attached to the transfer bar. Two hollow steel sleeves of one-piece construction, with an external diameter of 7.9 mm, +0 mm, -0.8 mm, (5/16 +0, -1/32)", shall be firmly attached to the bottom angle. When the binder is assembled, posts shall telescope freely into the hollow steel sleeves without binding. Posts and sleeves shall be spaced on 11.4 cm (4-1/4"), 17.8 cm (7"), or 22.9 cm (9") centers, as specified (see 8.1.8).

3.1.14. Class 3. Three solid steel posts, not less than 4.8 mm (3/16") diameter, shall be firmly attached to the transfer bar. Three hollow steel sleeves of one-piece construction, with an external diameter of 9.5 mm, +0 mm, -0.8 mm, (3/8, +0, -1/32)", shall be firmly attached to the bottom angle. When binder is assembled, posts shall telescope freely into the hollow steel sleeves without binding. The outer posts and sleeves shall be placed on 17.1 cm (6-3/4"), 17.8 cm (7"), or 27.9 cm (9") centers, as specified (see 8.1.9). The middle post and sleeve shall be centered between the outer posts and sleeves.

3.1.15. Class 4. Three solid steel posts, not less than 6.4 mm (1/4") diameter, shall be firmly attached to the bottom angle. Two hollow steel sleeves, of one piece construction with an external diameter of 7.9 mm, +0 mm, -0.8 mm, (5/16, +0, -1/32)", shall be firmly attached to separate aligner bar. Sleeves shall fit freely over two outside posts in bottom angle. The outside posts shall be spaced 17.8 cm (7") center to center; inside spacing between posts shall be 8.9 cm (3-1/2") center to center. The two sleeves shall be spaced 17.8 cm (7") center to center.

3.1.16. Classes 5, 6, and 7. Binders shall be equipped with posts and sleeves similar to those specified for Class 2 binders. The posts and sleeves shall be firmly attached to both bottom and top angles and shall be of proper length to hold binder capacity. Posts and sleeves for Class 5 shall be spaced on 17.8 cm (7") or 27.9 cm (9") centers; for Class 6 on 8.9 cm (3-1/2") or 11.4 cm (4-1/2") centers. For Class 7, the outer posts and sleeves shall be spaced on 17.8 cm (7") centers and the inner posts and sleeves on 11.4 cm (4-1/2") centers.

3.1.17. Class 8. Binders shall be equipped with four solid metal posts 6.0 ± 0.4 mm (15/64 ± 1/64)" in diameter. Two posts shall be attached to the bottom angle and two to the aligner (transfer bar). The outer posts shall be spaced on 20.3 cm (8") centers and the inner posts on 10.2 cm (4") centers.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2. Dimensions. Unless otherwise specified, Type I and II binders shall be in the sheet sizes specified, with the first dimension being the binding edge (see 2). The outside dimensions of the binders shall be sufficiently larger than the sheet size specified to protect the filler sheets and the index tabs (see 3.1.9).

3.3. Materials.

3.3.1. Grade A, coated cloth bound. Covers for Grade A binders shall be in accordance with commercial item description A-A-2549.

3.3.2. Grade B, canvas cloth bound. Covers for Grade B binders shall be bound with cotton (Army) duck consisting of two-ply yarns in both the warp and filling directions. The duck shall conform to the requirements of CCC-C-419, Type III, finished weight - 280 $g/m^2$ (8.25 $oz/yd^2$), except that the minimum yarns per 2.54 cm (1"), shall be 52 in the warp direction and 40 in the filling direction. The canvas shall have a colorfastness to crocking rating of not less than "fair", when tested in accordance with Fed.Std.191/5651.

3.3.3. Metal finish. All metal parts which will be exposed upon completion of the fabrication of the binders, shall be corrosion resistant or have a corrosion resistant finish in accordance with normal commercial practice.

3.3.4. Covers. Covers of binders shall be made from paperboard with a thickness of not less than 3.0 mm (0.117"), and a commercial grade suitable for the purpose intended.

3.3.5. Lining. The lining material for inside faces of covers shall be a suitable paper in accordance with normal commercial practice. Color of lining shall be in accordance with normal commercial practice.

3.3.6. Posts and sleeves. Posts and sleeves shall be made of steel hardened to not less than 52 on the Rockwell B Scale, when tested in accordance with ASTM E 18.

3.3.7. Angle backs. Angle backs shall be formed from 1/4 hard cold-rolled strip steel, 0.9 mm (0.035") thick, formed to a 90 degree angle. Metal angles shall be black oxide or phosphate treated and properly sized.

3.3.8. Aligner (transfer bar). Aligner shall be made from 1/2 hard-temper round edge cold-rolled steel having a thickness of not less than 1.27 mm (0.050") or from 1/4 hard-temper round edge cold-rolled steel having a thickness of not less than 1.6 mm (0.0625"). Transfer bar shall be black oxide or phosphate-treated, and shall be black-lacquer sprayed or electroplated in zinc or cadmium.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4. Workmanship. Binders shall be finished in a neat and workmanlike manner. Edges and surfaces, including exposed surfaces of metals, shall be smooth, securely fastened, and shall not cut or otherwise mar surfaces with which they make contact and shall not cut the fingers or hands of operators. Binders shall be free from defects which affect their appearance or which might impair their serviceability.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS:

4.1 Certification (paperboard). The contractor shall certify that the paperboard used in the manufacture of this item contains a minimum of 80 % Post Consumer Recovered Material (PCRM), in accordance with Code 40 of the Federal Regulations Part 247, Comprehensive Guideline for Procurement of Products Containing Recovered Materials; Final Rule. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery, and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE:

5.1. Product conformance. The product provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this document, conform to producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2. Testing. End item inspection/testing shall be implemented once in the beginning of the contract and may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in-process quality controls. For the remainder of the contract, suppliers are encouraged to use in process controls as a substitute for end item performance testing.

5.3. In-Process Quality Control. Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3/ American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. Objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.4. Sampling. Samples shall be selected for inspection in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI)/ American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes, using the plans in Table I below. A lot shall consist of a number of binders manufactured by the same process from the same components at the same time. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot for the end item inspection.

Table I

| Inspection | Inspection Level | AQL (%) defective | Sample Unit | Requirements Paragraph/s |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Construction | I | 2.5 | 1 Binder | 1A |
| Dimensions | S-2 | 4.0 | 1 Binder | 1A, 1B |
| Materials | S-2 | 4.0 | * | 1C |
| Workmanship | I | 4.0 | 1 Binder | 1D |

* Component testing: Five 25.4 cm (10") pieces of canvas cloth bound (Grade B); 0.9 meter (1 yard) full width of coated cloth bound (Grade A); Five 25.4 cm x 25.4 cm (10 x 10)" pieces of cover board and lining material (sampling plans for cover board or paper lining material shall be done as per TAPPI T 410); Two of each individual metal items or parts used in binders. Certificates of compliance are acceptable for the component testing. If certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check the validity of such certification.

5.4.1. Binders shall be tested by opening and closing in the normal matter. This shall be done 10 times to insure that the locking device operates smoothly and without breakdown. Any tendency of the device to stick or bind on the locking post, making it difficult to open or close the binder, shall be considered as not acceptable and the entire lot shall be rejected.

6. PACKAGING, PACKING AND MARKING: Packing, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

7. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS: The issue of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

7.1. CFR, Title 40, Code of Federal Regulations, Protection of the Environment, Part 247. Copies may be purchased with a VISA, Master Card or prepaid check through: Government Printing Office, Washington DC; Phone 202-783-3238. When ordering ask for: Title 40, Parts 190-250; Stock Number: 869-013-00-146-0.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

7.2. Federal Standards & Specifications may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington DC 20407.

7.3. (ANSI)/ American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes, can be obtained from: American Society for Quality Control, P.O. Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

7.4. American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) methods, can be obtained from: American Society for Testing and Materials; 1916 Race Street; Philadelphia, PA 19103.

7.5. Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) methods, can be obtained from: Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry; Technology Park/ Atlanta; P.O. Box 105113; Atlanta, GA 30348.

8. NOTES.

8.1. ORDERING DATA: Purchasers shall specify the following in the contract or purchase order.

8.1.1. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
8.1.2. Type, Class, Grade, Size and Capacity required.
8.1.3. Sheet size, post spacing for Class 2, 3, 5, 6 & 7.
8.1.4. Color of binder required.
8.1.5. Size and location of label holders, if required.
8.1.6. Packaging, packing, and marking required.
8.1.7. If special marking “Property of U.S. Government”, required.
8.1.8. Posts & sleeves spacing for Class 2.
8.1.9. Posts & sleeves spacing for Class 3.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

8.2. Item Identifiers/Reference Part Number System (for cataloging use only)

AA2788A- 2 7 B

This example describes an end locking, with outer posts and sleeves spaced on 17.8 cm (7") centers and inner posts and sleeves on 11.4 cm (4-1/2") centers, canvas bound.

A-Grade A - Coated cloth bound
B-Grade B - Canvas bound

1-Class 1 - see 1.A.12
2-Class 2 - see 1.A.13
3-Class 3 - see 1.A.14
4-Class 4 - see 1.A.15
5-Class 5 - see 1.A.16
6-Class 6 - see 1.A.16
7-Class 7 - see 1.A.16
8-Class 8 - see 1.A.17

1-Type I - Lift ring, center locking
2-Type II - End locking

MILITARY INTERESTS:

DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.